



Figure 3: Icecast server status page

section to reflect `<chroot>1</chroot>`. Enter the user as Icecast, and enter the group also as Icecast. More on this later. For now, also change the paths to:

```
<paths>
<basedir>/usr/share/icecast</basedir>
<logdir>/log</logdir>
<webroot>/web</webroot>
<adminroot>/admin</adminroot>
</paths>
```

Save the file and create a user Icecast with the default group Icecast, and the home directory as `/usr/share/Icecast/` as follows:

```
useradd -g icecast -d /usr/share/icecast/ icecast
```

That's about it. Run Icecast with the following command:

```
icecast -b -c /etc/icecast.xml
```

To test if Icecast is really working, open `http://localhost:8000/` in your Web browser (replace 8000 with the port you are using). You should be greeted with an "Icecast2 Status" page (refer to Figure 3). This indicates that everything is running properly.

How to stream using MPD

All right, you have installed and configured Icecast. The next step now is to add the Icecast stream channel as the output for MPD. You will have to decide what stream you want to use (Ogg or MP3) and change the options accordingly. Just add the following to the audio outputs section in the `mpd.conf` file:

```
audio_output {
    type "shout"
    encoding "ogg"          # change to mp3 for mp3 stream.
    name "foobar stream"
    port "8000"             # the port you are using
    host "localhost"        # the host in use.
```

```
format "44100:16:2"      # 44KHz 16 bit 2 channel audio.
mount "/stream.ogg"      # Change to /stream.mp3 for mp3.
password "somepass"      # The password for 'source'.
quality "2"              # optional for ogg stream.
bitrate "64"             # optional for mp3 stream.
user "source"
```

Then add the following lines in case you are NOT using Alsa as the second audio out, to make sure MPD does not crash when Icecast is not running:

```
audio_output {
    type "alsa"
    name "fake out"
    driver "null"
}
```

Well, that's it folks. All you need to do is to start Icecast and restart MPD.

```
/etc/rc.d/icecast start
/etc/rc.d/mpd restart
```

Here, make sure that Icecast is started before MPD in order to allow MPD to recognise it. You can add both the daemons to the start-up list. Just add their names to `/etc/rc.conf` file. Make sure that the Icecast statement is before `mpd` on that file.

How to play the stream

If you have reached this point without any trouble, then it's fairly simple to play the stream. If you are using a Linux machine to play the songs, you have numerous options. Almost all the standard players come with stream input compatibility. It's available in MPlayer, Amarok, Exaile, Rhythmbox, and many others. The term used is either an Internet radio stream or just a streaming media. For Windows, you can use Winamp.

I started out doing this for iPod Touch. I found a free application called MPoD for iPod that can either be used as a controller for MPD or as a player with Icecast. If you are unsure whether your player can play the audio streams, please Google for the information, as providing a how-to for all players in this guide is impossible and impractical.

You now have yourself an Internet radio. Go test it out and, of course, don't forget to have some fun. **END** 🐼

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